

OpenEd Impact and What We Are Fixing in EdTech

Purpose

This document defines the impact thesis. OpenEd is not just a nicer course UI. It is an attempt to fix structural weaknesses in online learning.

What current edtech often gets wrong

1. Passive learning

Many courses are videos with quizzes attached. Learners watch, pause, forget, and move on.

OpenEd fix:

- Active lesson workspace.
- Practice tasks.
- AI tutor.
- Artifacts.
- Feedback.

2. Weak doubt-solving

Learners often get stuck and leave. Paid tutors or communities are not always accessible.

OpenEd fix:

- AI tutor in every lesson.
- Prompt chips for common doubts.
- Source-grounded answers.
- Escalation/reporting.

3. No trust map

Courses rarely show where claims come from. Learners do not know what is required and what is advanced.

OpenEd fix:

- Source cards.
- Required vs optional labels.
- Difficulty tags.
- Lesson-source mapping.

4. Weak assessment

Quizzes are often too easy; exams can be too heavy or external. Certificates become weak signals.

OpenEd fix:

- Proof ladder.
- Practice tasks.
- Artifacts.
- Rubrics.
- Revision history.
- SkillProof portfolios.

5. Educator quality is unclear

Some platforms require famous institutions; others allow anyone to upload low-quality courses.

OpenEd fix:

- Educator Studio.
- Publish-readiness QA.
- Source mapping.
- Rubrics.
- OpenEd Team review.

6. AI is bolted on

Many platforms add chatbots but do not redesign learning.

OpenEd fix:

- Tutor integrated into lesson context, sources, practice, artifacts, and rubrics.

7. Learners pay before proof

Many platforms charge before learners know if the course fits.

OpenEd fix:

- Free learner access.
- BYOK/optional managed AI later.
- Portfolio-based outcome.

Impact goals

Learner impact

- Improve course completion.
- Improve self-efficacy.
- Increase practice and artifact creation.
- Make advanced learning paths clearer.
- Give learners portable proof.

Educator impact

- Lower course creation friction.
- Improve instructional quality.
- Make source-backed teaching easier.
- Help educators design better assessments.

Ecosystem impact

- Normalize proof over certificates.
- Raise quality standards for AI-assisted courses.
- Make free serious learning more accessible.

Impact metrics

Impact area	Metric
Access	Learners enrolled for free.
Engagement	Lesson completion and return rate.
Learning	Quiz improvement after feedback.
Practice	Practice and artifact completion.
Proof	Portfolio items created/shared.

Impact area	Metric
Trust	Source drawer open and source trust ratings.
Tutor value	Tutor helpfulness and hallucination reports.
Educator quality	QA pass rate and revision cycles.

Social externalities to watch

Positive:

- More learners can access serious courses.
- Learners with low confidence can ask questions privately.
- Educators can teach without expensive production teams.
- Proof becomes more democratic.

Negative:

- Learners may over-rely on AI.
- AI may produce false confidence.
- Poor courses may scale if QA fails.
- BYOK may confuse or exclude some learners.
- Artifacts may be fabricated with AI.

Impact guardrail

OpenEd should not optimize only for completion. Completion can be gamed. The deeper metric is:

Learner produces a meaningful artifact and can explain it.

That is the beginning of proof.

Source notes

This document is grounded in the current OpenEd/FME project context and the following reference set where applicable:

- Uploaded Frontier Model Evaluations prototype code bundle, latest inspected bundle: Design System for Frontier Model Evaluation (5).zip.

- Uploaded Frontier Model Evaluations 51-hour curriculum and Module 1 foundations files.
- Coursera, Udemy, DataCamp, Moodle, Khanmigo, Duolingo public documentation and product pages.
- Supabase Auth and Row Level Security documentation.
- OpenAI API key safety guidance, MDN Web APIs, and YouTube IFrame Player API documentation.
- Bloom's 2 sigma problem, intelligent tutoring systems research, CourseAssist, LearnLM-Tutor, DCCI, and UNESCO guidance for generative AI in education.

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